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CONTENTSYSTEM.AI

MODULE 6.1

The Core *Criteria*

A framework to judge whether a product is worth running.
Several criteria, not all weighted the same.

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The Core *Criteria*

Once you have a product in front of you, you need a framework to judge whether it is worth running. There are several criteria. They are not in strict order, but some matter more than others, and I will tell you which.

CRITERION ONE · HIGHEST WEIGHT

Problem-solving or value-providing

This is one of the most important. Your product needs to solve an issue or provide real value, because that is what drives conversion. Value comes in a few different forms.

Problem-solving

The most direct. Someone has back pain, the product fixes it. Anything that makes life easier, faster, or more practical.

Emotional

The product connects to a feeling. A digital frame or piece of jewelry displaying someone's pet. The pull is the emotion attached to it.

Experience

A jewelry holder shaped like a teddy bear that opens to reveal a ring. An advent calendar. The value is in the experience.

Figure out which kind of value the product provides. **Sparking emotion in particular is one of the most powerful things for both going viral and converting**, because emotion creates the impulse to buy. Emotion can also be built into your content. But a product that has emotion or a strong use case built into it is already ahead.

CRITERION TWO

Wow factor or virality

This ties closely to value but stands on its own. Your product needs a wow factor, because if it is too boring, too generic, or too widely available, it is very hard to go viral. **You cannot go viral showing a plain fork.** Nobody cares about a fork. But something that lights up, moves in an unusual way, or does something people have not seen before gives the viewer that stop. They are scrolling, they hit your video, and the product makes them pause because they do not even know what they are looking at. As organic marketers, going viral is the whole game.

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CRITERION THREE

Aesthetically pleasing or emotion-sparking

This overlaps with wow factor and virality. Some products have emotion or aesthetic appeal built right in. A frame showing a lost pet carries emotion inside the product itself. A camera that captures a retro aesthetic ties people emotionally to that era. **Not required for every product**, but if your product and content are aesthetically pleasing and spark emotion, going viral gets a lot easier. Like emotion, the aesthetic can also come from your content, not just the product.

THE MOST COMMON WASTE OF TIME

The mid product trap.

There is one category of product that is the most common waste of time in this business, and **beginners run them constantly**. It is called the **mid product**. A mid product is one that does not fit either of the two winning shapes.

It is *not* a high-converting value or problem-solving product, and it is *not* a super-wow-factor product that can do massive views on look alone. **It sits in the middle.** The kind of product that could make you 5 to 10K in a month, but is not going to put up the 40K, 60K, 100K months.

If you run a mid product, that is the ceiling, and **it eats the same time and effort as running a real winner**.

The two shapes you actually want are clear: either **a product with high enough perceived value and a real problem-solving angle that it converts hard**, or **a product with such a strong wow factor that it can ride enormous view counts to real revenue**. If a product is neither, it is mid, and mid is not worth your slot. **Pass and find a real one.**

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CRITERION FOUR · OFTEN MISUNDERSTOOD

Not sold like a generic store product

There used to be a hard rule that you should never run anything people can buy at Walmart or a dollar store. There is truth in that for plain, generic products. **Nobody is going to buy a basic fork from you when they can grab one anywhere.**

But do not take this too literally. It is not really about whether the item physically exists in a store. It is about whether the product feels generic and expected. A problem-solving product can technically be available at a store and still work, as long as it has a wow factor and does not feel like something people would expect to see on a shelf. An ear cleaner is a good example. You could probably find some version at a local store, but a unique one, shown the right way, still prints, because it is solving a real problem and has that "I've never seen this before" reaction built in.

The real rule: avoid plain, generic, instantly-recognizable products with no wow factor and no shown value. But a problem-solving or value product is not disqualified just because a version of it exists in retail.

THE UNDERLYING TRUTH

This is all about the marketing. With the right marketing you can take almost any product viral. **A beginner should lean on genuinely good products**, because the product covers for marketing that is still developing. More advanced operators can run saturated products, rinse old concepts, and still win, because they understand the marketing well enough to carry a weaker or more competitive product. Strong marketing is the engine. The product just decides how hard you have to work.

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CRITERION FIVE

A targeted audience and, more importantly, a passionate niche

For a big winning product you usually need both, and these are not the same thing. If you cannot say what niche you are running the product in, do not run it, because your targeting will be so loose that nobody buys.

Targeted niche is a defined group, like soccer players. **Passionate niche** is a group that is passionate about buying things related to their interest. Soccer players are a targeted niche, but they are not especially passionate about buying soccer stuff. Sell Ronaldo posters and people will not actually buy them. Golf players, on the other hand, are passionate about buying golf things. That is a passionate niche.

Some niches are simply better than others, for two reasons. **Disposable income:** golf players and equestrians have money to spend, because you need money to do those activities. **Targeting quality:** golf naturally hits North America and other regions that convert. Compare that to anime, where you end up targeting a lot of international traffic that is much harder to convert.

A product without an obvious niche can still work if you assign it one. A camera has no built-in niche, but you can run it in the horse niche, baseball, golf, and so on. **The point is to niche it down into something passionate.**

CRITERION SIX

Multiple content concepts

If you want a product that lasts, you need to know at least a few different content ideas for it before you commit. If you only have one concept and it does not go viral, you are stuck. **If you cannot picture several pieces of content for a product, you will probably just waste time on it.**

In the old version of this business, a related concern was whether you could physically film for a product. With AI, that constraint mostly disappears. The question shifts: instead of asking whether you can film it, ask whether you can **generate good content for it** and whether you have multiple concepts to run.

"A product that provides real value, has a wow factor, sparks emotion, is not sold locally, sits in a passionate niche, and has

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several content concepts you can run, you are looking at a genuine winner."

ONE LEVER ON TOP OF IT ALL

Positioning a product as handmade.

When a product is marketed as handmade, two things happen at once. Its **perceived value goes up**, because handmade feels more valuable than mass-produced. And it gains an **emotional wow factor**, because people react to the idea that a real person made it.

A fairly ordinary product can become a strong seller when it is positioned as handmade inside a passionate niche with a real daily use. **The handmade angle is one of the most effective ways to lift an average product into a winner.**